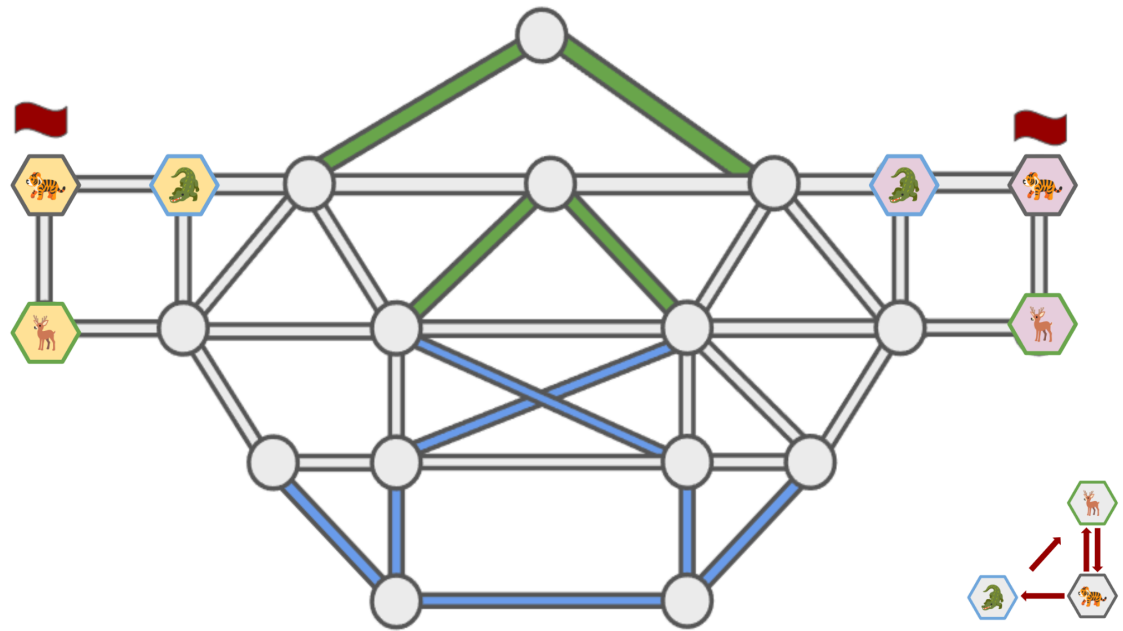


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The updated version is a 2-player abstract strategy board game based on a simplified Jungle-style animal conflict system. Each player controls three animals — Tiger, Crocodile, and Deer — and tries to either capture all of the opponent's pieces or invade the opponent's home area. In this updated version, the map has been changed so the Crocodile has more movement options in the middle of the board, while some of the Deer-only routes have been reduced. The turn system has also been changed into a phase-based unit activation system, where each player must move all of their remaining animals once before they can start reusing them again.

//The board is asymmetric by design — Player 2's side has one extra diagonal route to compensate for moving second.



Piece	Terrain Access	Beats	Loses to
Tiger	Land	Crocodile, Deer, Tiger	Deer, Tiger
Deer	Land + Forest (green)	Tiger, Deer	Crocodile, Tiger, Deer
Crocodile	Land + Water (blue)	Deer, Crocodile	Tiger, Crocodile

Starting positions: All 3 pieces begin inside their respective home wing.

Rules:

1. Players alternate turns. P1 goes first. On your turn, move exactly one piece one step along any passable adjacent edge. Each player must move all of their remaining animals once before they can start reusing them again.
2. You may not move onto a node occupied by your own piece.
3. Moving onto an enemy piece triggers combat — the losing piece is permanently removed. The winner stays.
4. Win by Elimination — capture all 3 enemy pieces, or Win by Invasion — move any piece into any node of the enemy home wing.

Game basics: genre, number of players, premise

Genre: abstract strategy game.

Number of players: 2

Premise: both players command the same set of three animals, but each animal has different movement options and combat strengths. The game is about positioning, predicting the opponent's choices, and using the map well.

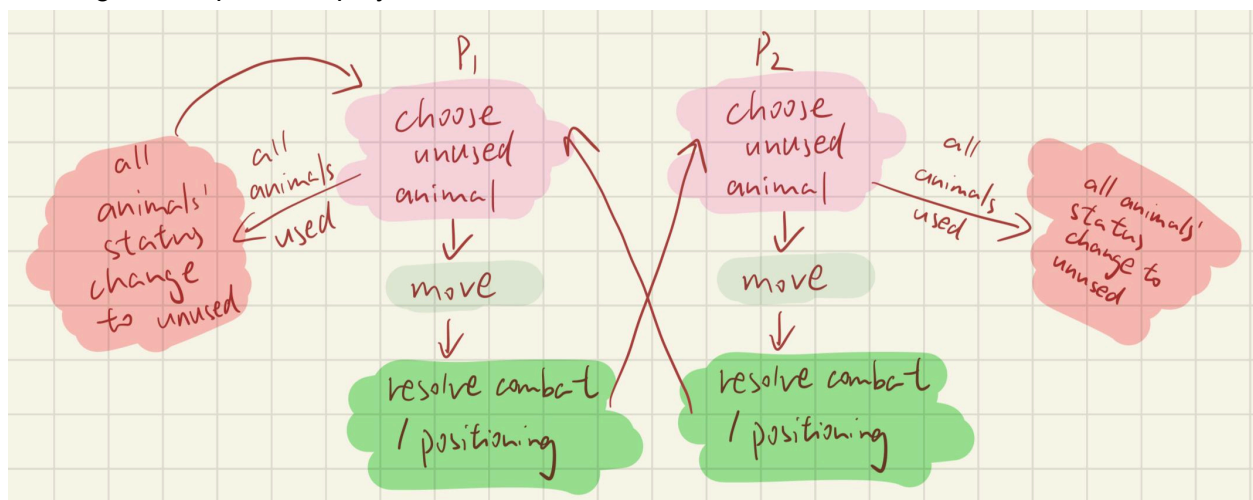
What is the overall player experience? What do they do and how do they feel?

The experience should feel tactical and tense, because players take turns moving to open a path toward the opponent's home side. Because players now have to move each animal once per round, they cannot rely on only their strongest or most convenient piece. This makes the experience feel more balanced and more strategic, because players must plan not only where to move, but also when to use each animal.

What is the game loop?

Game loop for one player: choose an unused animal → move → resolve combat/positioning → continue until all animals have acted → refresh for the next round

Whole game loop for two players:



How is the game played?

Each player begins with a Tiger, a Crocodile, and a Deer in their home wing. On a turn, a player selects one animal that has not yet been used in the current round and moves it one step along an adjacent legal route. Different routes support different animals, so movement is still terrain-based. If a piece moves onto a node occupied by an enemy piece, combat happens immediately and the losing piece is removed. A player wins by either eliminating all enemy animals or moving any of their pieces into the opponent's home territory. Compared with the earlier version, the updated map gives the Crocodile more central access and reduces some of the Deer's exclusive routing. The new round structure also forces all pieces to matter during play.

A reflection:

- **What is working well in this version of the game?**

This version improves the balance between the three animals. The Crocodile now has a clearer purpose because it can travel through more central routes and participate in the main conflict more often. Reducing some Deer-only paths also helps prevent the Deer from having too much special mobility. The new phase-based activation rule works very well because it encourages players to think about all of their pieces instead of repeatedly using the same one. It also creates an interesting comeback effect: if a player has lost a piece, they only need to move their remaining two animals before their full set refreshes, so their available pieces cycle faster than the opponent's. This gives the player with fewer pieces a small tempo advantage and helps them stay competitive instead of falling behind too quickly.

- **What isn't working / could be improved?**

One thing we want to improve is the animal relationship itself. Right now, it is not very intuitive that the Deer can beat the Tiger, and our playtesters often forgot that rule during the game. Because of that, we are considering modifying the animal design or changing the animal set so the strength relationships feel more natural and easier to remember. Another issue is that players sometimes forget which animals have already been used in the current round, so the activation system needs a clearer tracking method. We also noticed that the first player does not seem to have a strong advantage in playtesting, so the extra diagonal route that was originally added to compensate for Player 2 may no longer be necessary.

- **How do you plan to iterate?**

In the next iteration, we plan to revise the animal system so the combat relationships are easier to understand and remember. We also plan to use two-sided pieces in the physical prototype to help track the phase-based activation rule: after an animal is used in a round, we will flip that piece over to show that it has already acted. This should make the turn structure clearer during play. In addition, since the first player does not seem to have much advantage, we want to test removing the extra diagonal route that was originally added for Player 2 compensation.